

POISONER



(/File:Icon_poisoner.png)

Information

Type Minion (/Character_Types#Minion)

Artist Aidan Roberts

"Add compound Alpha to compound Beta... NOT TOO MUCH!"

Appears in



(/Trouble_Brewing)

Cult of the Clocktower Episode

by Andrew Nathenson

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SUMMARY

"Each night, choose a player: they are poisoned tonight and tomorrow day."

The Poisoner secretly disrupts character abilities.

- Each night, the Poisoner chooses someone to poison for that night and the entire next day.
- A poisoned player has no ability, but the Storyteller pretends they do. They do not affect the game in any real way. However, to keep up the illusion that the poisoned player is not poisoned, the Storyteller wakes them at the appropriate time and goes through the motions as if they were not poisoned. If their ability gives them information, the Storyteller may give them false information.
- If a poisoned player uses a "once per game" ability while poisoned, they cannot use their ability again.

HOW TO RUN

Each night, wake the Poisoner. They point at any player. The chosen player becomes poisoned—put the **POISONED** reminder token by the chosen player's character token. Put the Poisoner to sleep. (This poisoned player wakes and acts normally. They have no ability, but they think they do. If their ability would give them information, you can give false information to them if you wish. See “Drunkenness and Poisoning” in the rulebook.)

Each dusk, the poisoned player becomes healthy—remove their **POISONED** reminder.

EXAMPLES



During the night, the Poisoner poisons the **Slayer** (/Slayer). The next day, the **Slayer** (/Slayer) tries to slay the **Imp** (/Imp). Nothing happens. The **Slayer** (/Slayer) now has no ability.



The poisoned **Empath** (/Empath), who neighbours two evil players, learns a "0." The next night, the **Empath** (/Empath), no longer poisoned, learns the correct information: a "2."





The **Investigator** (/Investigator) is poisoned. They learn that one of two players is the **Baron** (/Baron), even though neither is a Minion. (Or even the right players, but the wrong Minion type.)



The **Undertaker** (/Undertaker) is poisoned. Even though the **Imp** (/Imp) died today, they learn that the **Virgin** (/Virgin) died. A few days later, a poisoned **Saint** (/Saint) dies, and the game continues.



The Poisoner poisons the **Mayor** (/Mayor), then becomes the **Imp** (/Imp). The **Mayor** (/Mayor) is no longer poisoned because there is no Poisoner in play.



TIPS & TRICKS

- Identifying targets for poison is vital. Characters who get information over several nights like the **Fortune Teller** (/Fortune_Teller) or **Undertaker** (/Undertaker) are great choices if you can find them. You can also make your choice based on the player; players who are strong leaders and rallying the good team or players who are quiet and trying not to attract attention are good options.
- Undermine players who trust each other by poisoning the characters getting key info in that clique. If a group is rallying around an **Undertaker** (/Undertaker), you can turn the entire group on someone innocent by poisoning them at the right time.
- Co-ordinate with your Demon so that you are not selecting the same players - unless they are a character like the **Ravenkeeper** (/Ravenkeeper), you'll just be wasting your poison for the day!
- Targeting characters like the **Virgin** (/Virgin), **Slayer** (/Slayer) or **Mayor** (/Mayor) can be excellent, but only if they use their ability while they are poisoned. You'll need to convince them to use their ability, or time it right so that they are compromised at the moment they choose to activate.

- It's risky, but you can poison your own Demon, and use the lack of death for that night to bluff as the **Monk** (/Monk) or **Soldier** (/Soldier). (You should probably warn your Demon you're going to do this!)
- If everyone is on board with the idea, try poisoning the **Scarlet Woman** (/Scarlet_Woman). If the **Imp** (/Imp) chooses to kill themselves, the **Scarlet Woman** (/Scarlet_Woman) will become the new Demon... unless you poison them first! That way, you or a third Minion can become the new **Imp** (/Imp) and keep the **Scarlet Woman** (/Scarlet_Woman) in play. Just don't get your **Imp** (/Imp) killed while the **Scarlet Woman** (/Scarlet_Woman) is still poisoned!
- You will usually be more efficient as a Poisoner by selecting multiple targets around the town rather than focusing on one player for the entire game. You only really need to poison the **Fortune Teller** (/Fortune_Teller) on the night they're checking your Demon, for example - then you're free to mess with other characters. This method of poisoning is also more difficult to detect than sticking to one player.
- On the other hand, if you only poison one player, that player might end up looking like the **Drunk** (/Drunk), perhaps hiding the real **Drunk** (/Drunk), or making it look like a **Baron** (/Baron) is in play.
- On the first night, if you don't know who to poison, poison a player sitting next to the Demon. You know which player is the Demon, and on the off chance that an **Empath** (/Empath) is sitting next to the Demon, you'll be giving some very damaging information to the good team.
- Make use of your **Spy** (/Spy)! They know who the best targets are and can guide you in the right direction.

FIGHTING THE POISONER

- The Poisoner is unlikely to target you because of your ability on the first night, since they don't know anyone but their fellow evil players and will be acting blindly. Therefore, you can usually trust that your ability will work correctly on the first night and day. This is particularly important for characters like the **Virgin** (/Virgin) and the **Slayer** (/Slayer), who only get to use their abilities once, as well as the **Washerwoman** (/Washerwoman), **Librarian** (/Librarian), **Investigator** (/Investigator), and **Chef** (/Chef).
- The Poisoner will especially want to target characters who get information over multiple nights, such as the **Empath** (/Empath), **Undertaker** (/Undertaker) or **Fortune Teller** (/Fortune_Teller). They will also be keen to undermine characters like the **Slayer** (/Slayer), who can kill their Demon. If you think a Poisoner is in play, be cautious about these characters and their information, especially if they have come out publicly. However, if you believe a player has been poisoned, you can usually assume they were given false information by the Storyteller.

- If you are a character that would be unaffected by poison (e.g. **Butler** (/Butler), **Chef** (/Chef) who has gotten their info), you can try to bluff as a juicy target for the Poisoner, ensuring that they don't target anyone else.
- Separating the Poisoner from the **Drunk** (/Drunk) can be crucial. Knowing that you have one in play might signal what else is in the game. Uncovering a **Drunk** (/Drunk) might tell you that the **Recluse** (/Recluse) is telling you the truth, or that the **Butler** (/Butler) might be lying. The **Librarian** (/Librarian) or **Investigator** (/Investigator), **Undertaker** (/Undertaker), and **Ravenkeeper** (/Ravenkeeper) can be the best ways to find out which is in play, but a lot of different people getting wrong information might point to the Poisoner.
- Be alert for characters who suddenly start getting inconsistent information, especially if they have recently revealed to the group. For example, an **Empath** (/Empath) who is still sitting between the same neighbours but is suddenly getting a different number to the previous nights is likely poisoned.
- In the absence of more obvious targets, poisoners typically will end up targeting players that are:
 - Strong or outspoken, especially if they are rallying or leading the good team
 - Friends or loved ones - it's hard to resist!
 - Quiet, or are trying not to attract attention; these look like they have something to hide.
- Unlike other Minions, the Poisoner is deadly throughout the entire game so long as they are alive. If you have a lead on a suspected Poisoner, it is always to your benefit to take them out as early in the game as possible. For example, an **Investigator** (/Investigator) may know that one of two players is the Poisoner; it is best to execute them both. Alternatively, two players may be claiming to be the same character; this is usually an indication a Minion is doubling up with an existing good player, and eliminating both of them removes the Poisoner from contention.
- Remember that the Poisoner causes information to be misleading, not wrong. If you learn that you might have been poisoned, you might still have had true information!

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